



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – TPR Levi Champion #982

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 3 - Cartersville

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00160966

Related Crash Reports: C000948714 ; C000948715 ; _____

P.I.T. Involved: No

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: Yes

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 4/4/2024

Time: 1300 hours

Location: Post 3 - Cartersville

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Lieutenant Tim Nichols #36, SFC Frank Zepeda #283 and TPR Levi Champion #982

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 3/28/2024

Time: 2259 Hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

On 3/28/2024, at approximately 2259 hours, TPR Champion observed a gold Mazda SUV traveling east on GA 20 with only one operational headlight. At the intersection of GA 20 East and the ramp to I-75 South, TPR Champion attempted to stop the Mazda. The driver steered the vehicle to the right edge of the eastbound lane and stopped at the intersection. When the red traffic signal turned green, the suspect continued traveling eastbound. At the intersection of GA 20 East and the ramp from I-75 North, the suspect stopped briefly for the red traffic signal. The suspect then ran the red traffic light and a pursuit ensued.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☒ N/A If needed, list:

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: TPR Champion contacted the Troop A Communications Center by radio and advised them that he was attempting to stop the vehicle. TPR Champion gave his location, direction of travel and a description of the vehicle along with the tag number. Dispatcher McWhorter received this information and created a CAD call for the traffic stop. When the suspect began to drive off from the traffic stop, TPR Champion advised the Communications Center that he was in a pursuit.

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A

Explain: Once the pursuit initiated, Dispatcher McWhorter cleared the radio for emergency traffic before conducting a broadcast of the pursuit to all Troop A Troopers. Senior Dispatcher Smith contacted the Bartow County 911 Center to advise them of the pursuit and to request assistance.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: The pursuit initiated on GA 20 westbound at the ramp to I-75 South. The pursuit continued westbound before the suspect turned right onto Stone Mill Circle (a private gravel road). After turning onto Stone Mill Circle, the pursuit traveled in a southern direction through a dirt field and terminated when the violator struck a group of trees. The pursuit traveled approximately .67 miles and lasted one minute and one second.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☒ No If Yes, explain:

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☐ N/A

Explain: Due to no other officers being near the area of the pursuit, the Box-In maneuver and Stop Sticks were not an option, TPR Champion attempted to implement the Precision Immobilization Technique (PIT) maneuver. However, TPR Champion failed to match the violator's speed and properly make contact with the Mazda. As a result, the PIT was unsuccessful.

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A

Explain: TPR Champion utilized all his emergency equipment throughout the pursuit, exercised due regard at intersections and operated his patrol vehicle in a responsible manner.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during nighttime hours with clear skies and a dry road surface. The traffic conditions on GA 20 at the time of the pursuit would be considered light.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator failed to stop for traffic control devices and clearly demonstrated that he had no intentions of stopping for law enforcement. The violator's actions posed a great risk to himself and other motorists.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The right front push bumper of the Dodge and the left rear side of the Mazda sustained minor damage as a result of the unsuccessful PIT attempt. The Mazda sustained minor front end damage as a result of striking the trees at the end of the pursuit.

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: This was TPR Champion's 3rd pursuit as a Georgia State Trooper.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TPR Champion has received E.V.O.C., Advanced E.V.O.C. and Pursuit-Ending Tactics Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TPR Champion's commentating driving has improved since his prior pursuits.

2. Areas for improvement.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: If TPR Champion's PIT attempt had been successful in the manner in which he intended to implement it, it could have possibly caused the violator's vehicle to travel across the center of the road and into the opposing lanes and oncoming traffic. TPR Champion should always assess his surroundings before implementing a PIT maneuver.

3. Other considerations.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: At the conclusion of the pursuit, TPR Champion drew and pointed his service weapon while clearing the violator's vehicle.

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

Reviewing Officer

4/19/2024

Date